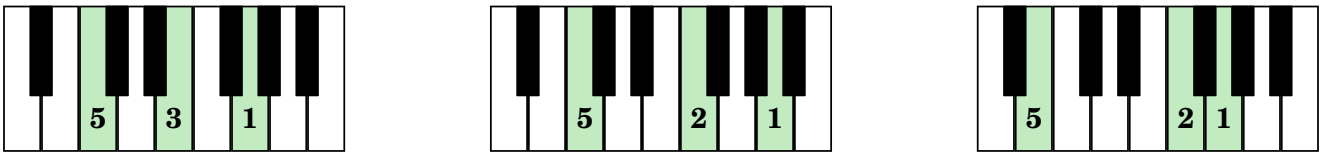
Unit 2

The Alberti Bass

New: Broken chords in eighth notes: low, high, middle, high

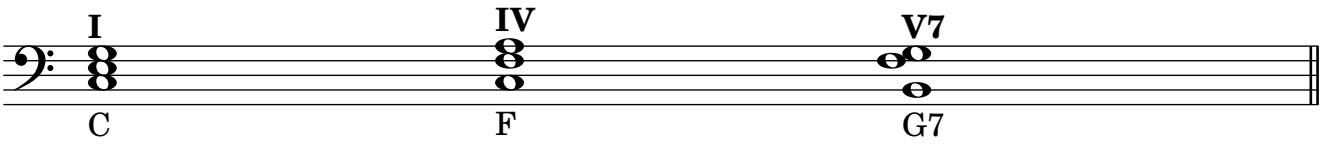
The Alberti bass is a broken chord in eighth notes: bottom, top, middle, top, over and over. It is named after Domenico Alberti, an Italian composer of the early 1700s, and you will hear it in countless pieces by Haydn, Mozart and Clementi. It keeps the music moving gently while the right hand sings above it. The chord shapes are the same as in Unit 1; only the order of the notes is new.

C major: left-hand chord shapes



I = C **IV** = F **V7** = G7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Bottom, top, middle, top

In C major the I chord becomes C G E G, C G E G. The thumb plays every second note, so the pattern rocks between finger 5, the thumb, finger 3 and the thumb.

IV and V7

IV becomes C A F A (fingers 5 1 2 1) and V7 becomes B G F G (5 1 2 1). The thumb stays on top; only fingers 5 and 2 or 3 change.

Eighths against quarters

The left hand plays two notes for every right-hand quarter note. Count 1-and-2-and: the right hand plays on the numbers only.

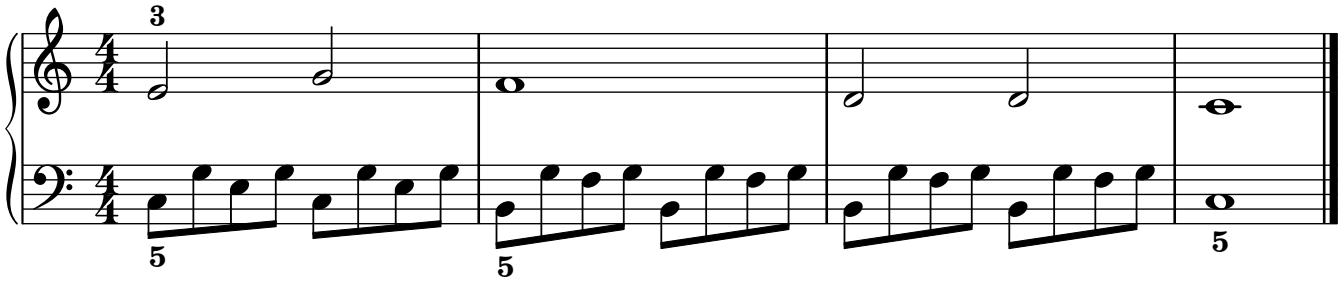
Reading tips

1. Before you start, find each new chord shape: a finger number under the bass marks it.
2. Keep the thumb light. The bottom note of each group carries the harmony; the thumb notes are softer.
3. Read the first four eighths of a bar as one shape; the rest of the bar repeats it, so your eyes can go back to the right hand.

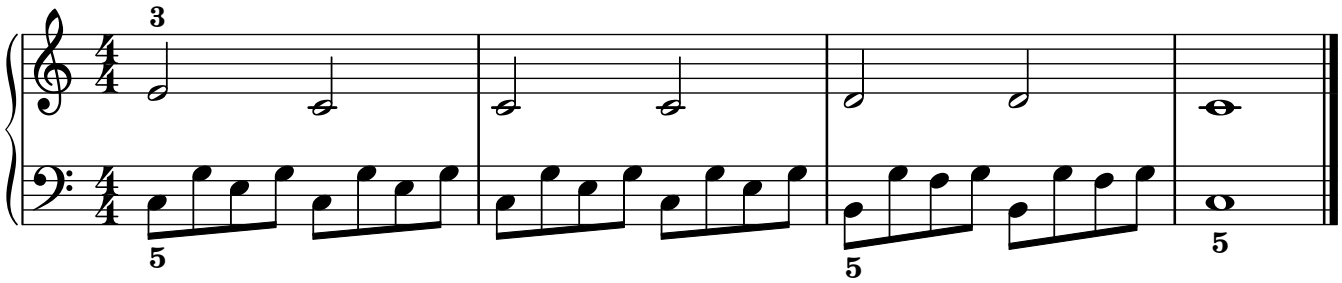
Part A: Alberti bass under long notes ♩ = 56

C major. The right hand plays half and whole notes over an Alberti bass on I and V7. Metronome 56.

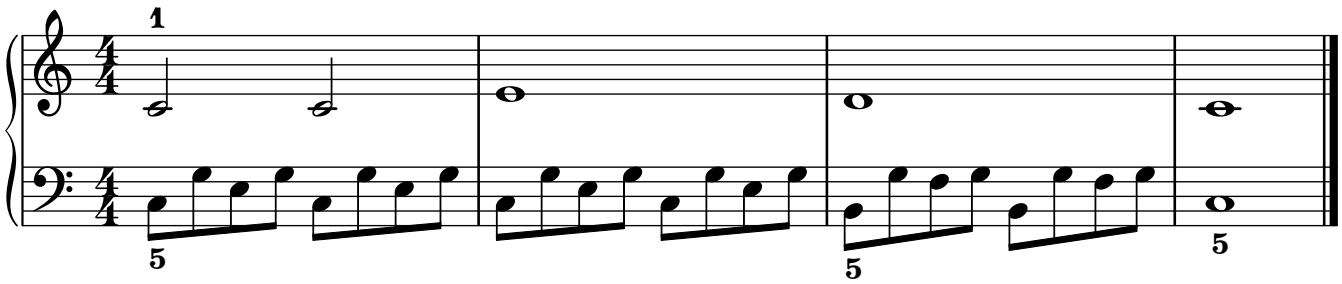
☐ **2.1**



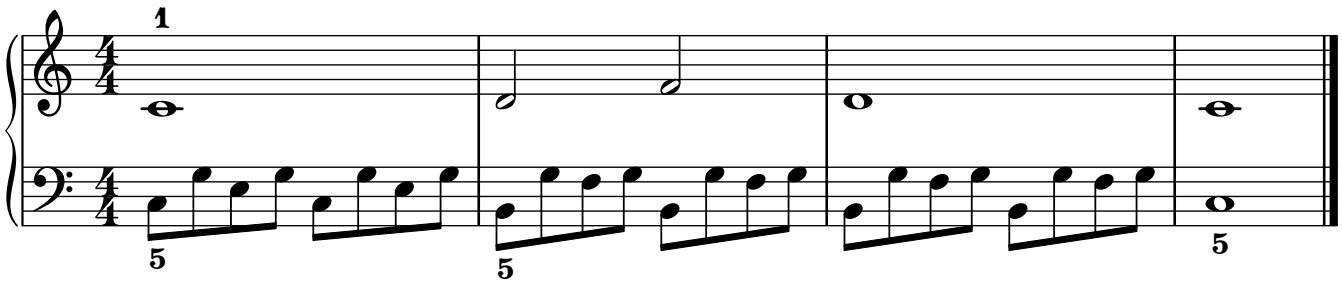
☐ **2.2**



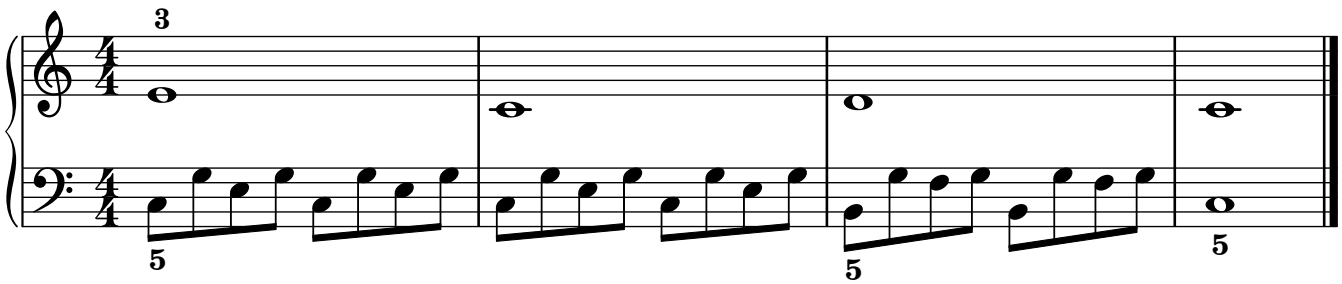
☐ **2.3**



☐ **2.4**



☐ **2.5**



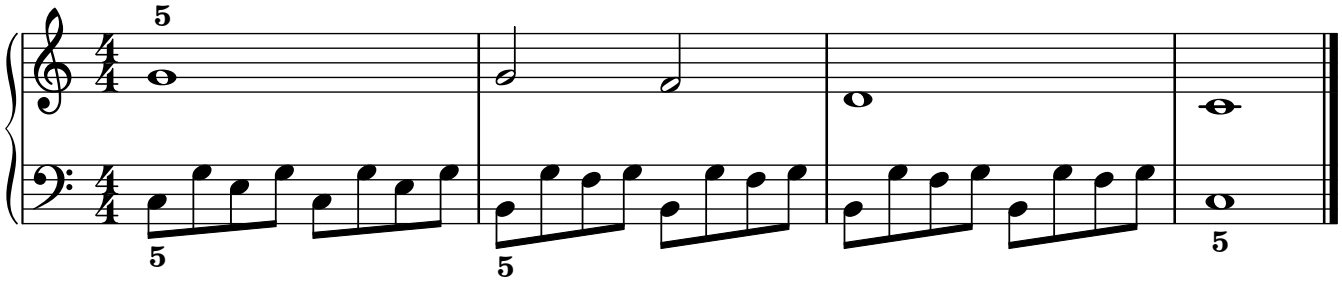
2.6



2.7



2.8



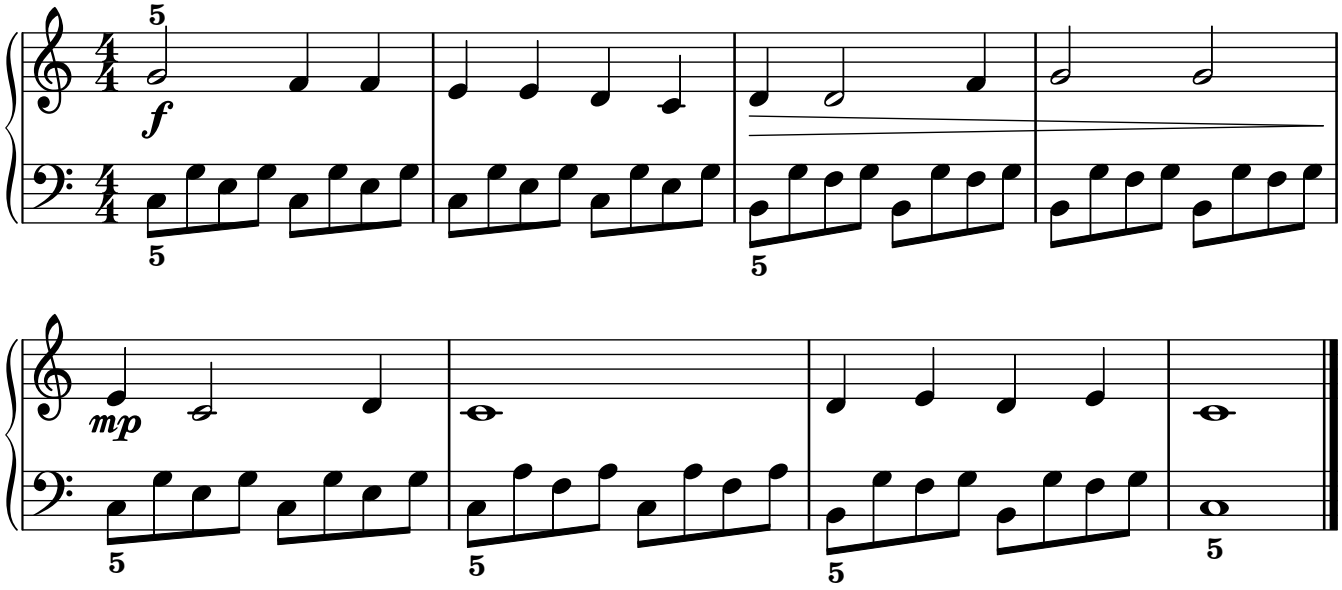
Part B: I, IV and V7 in C major ♩ = 60

Eight bars in C major with I, IV and V7, and dynamics.

☐ **2.9**



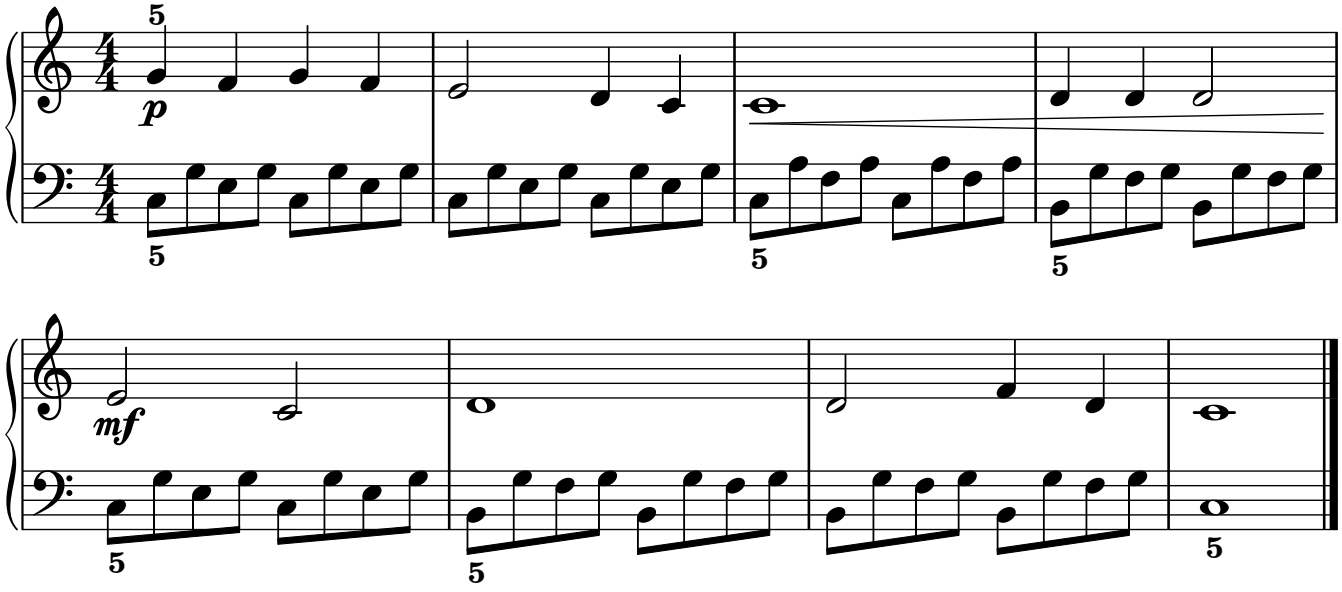
☐ **2.10**



2.11



2.12



2.13



2.14



2.15



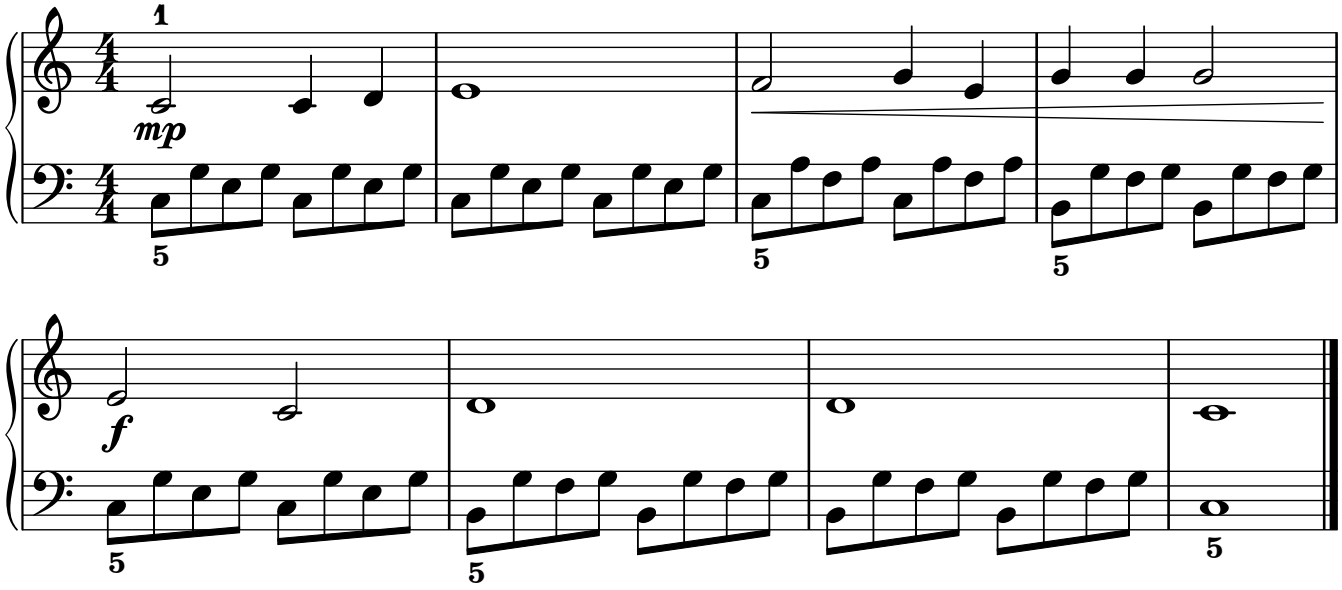
2.16



2.17



2.18

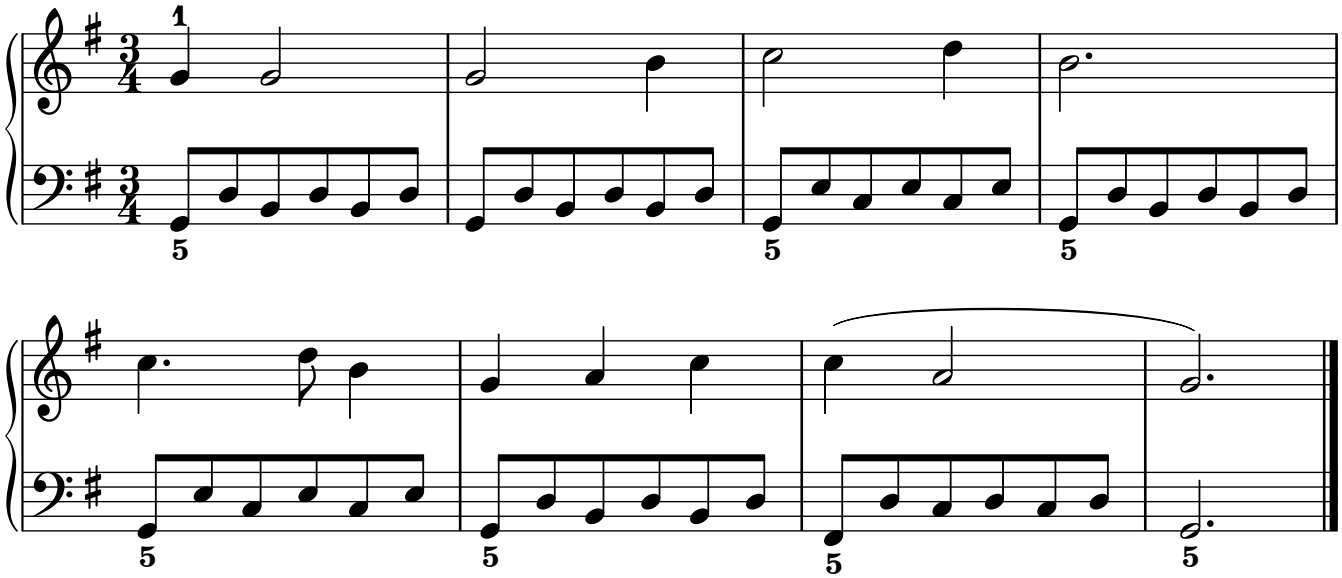


Part C: Alberti bass in 3/4

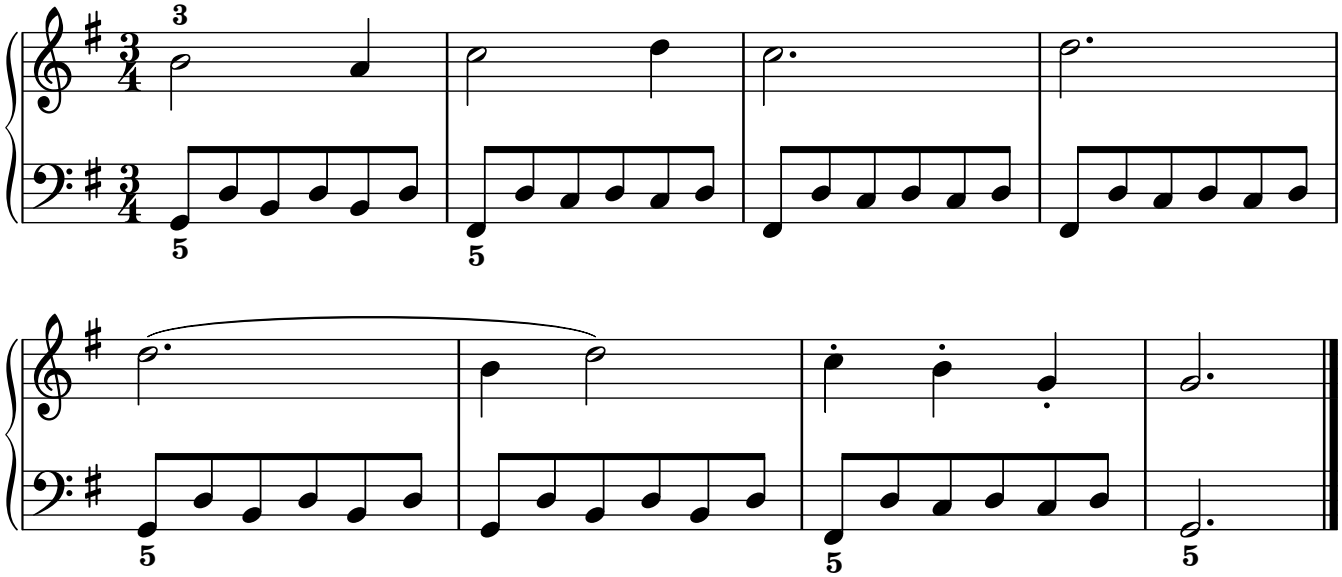
♩ = 66

G major in 3/4: the bass plays bottom, top, middle, top, middle, top - six eighths in a bar.

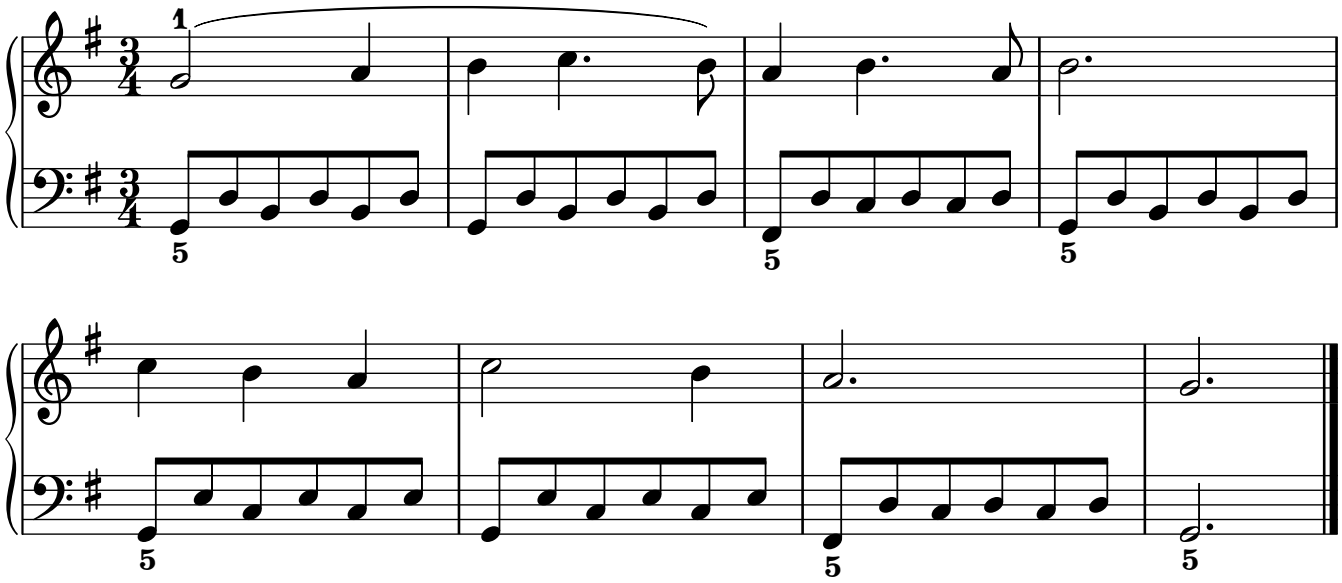
☐ **2.19**



☐ **2.20**



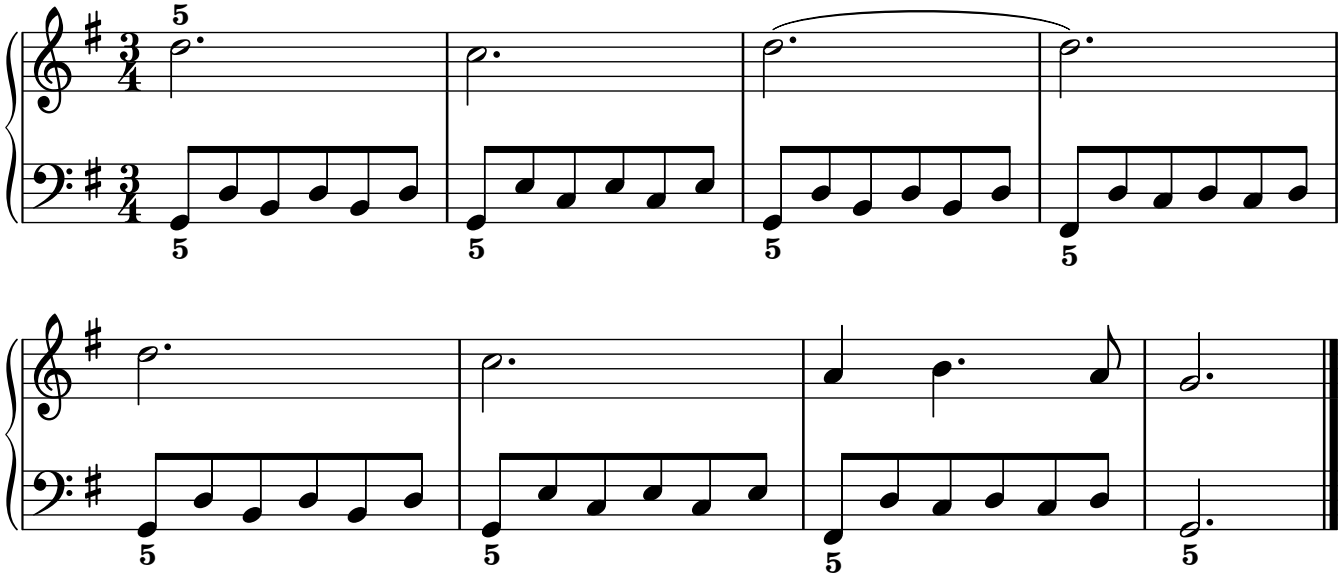
2.21



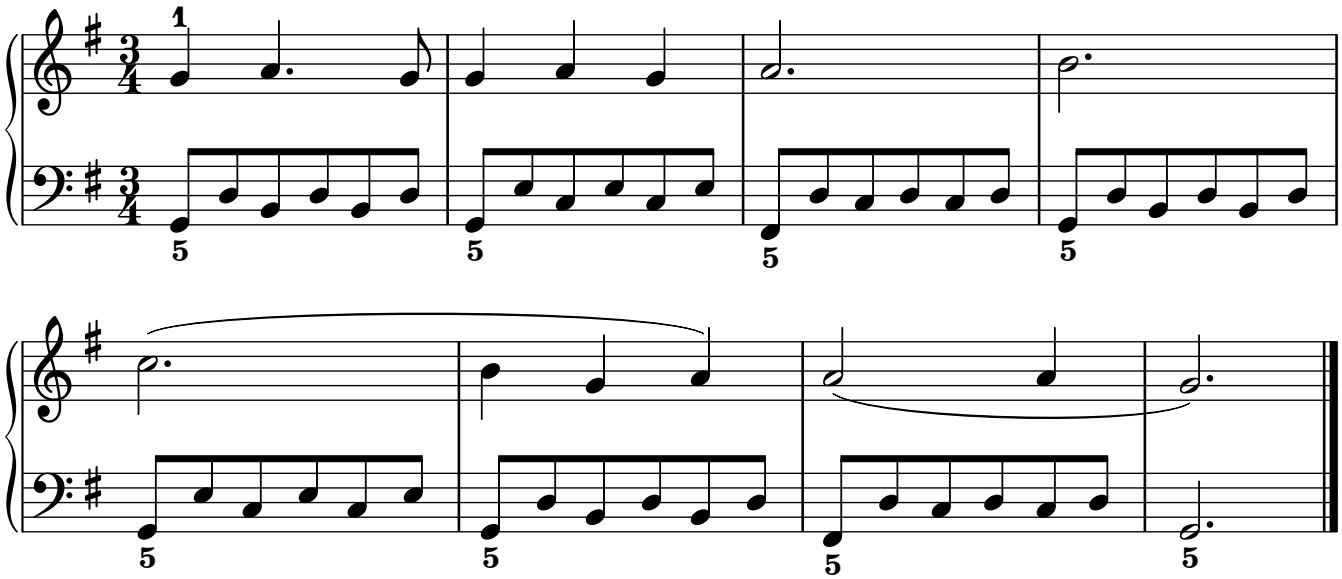
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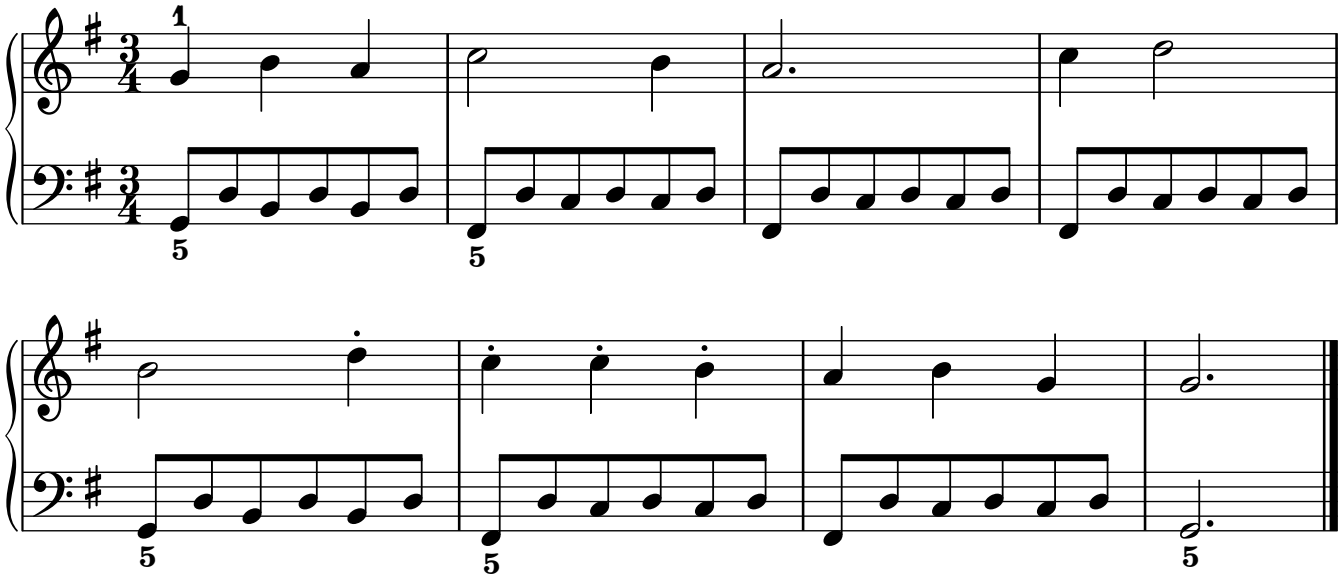
2.23



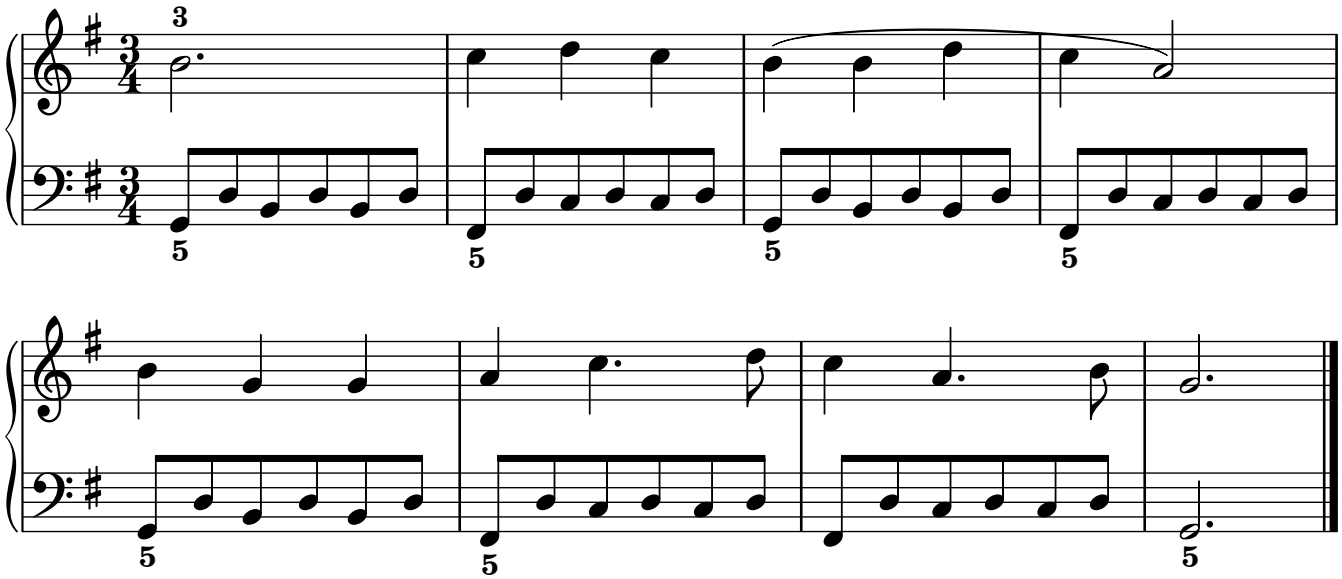
2.24



2.25



2.26

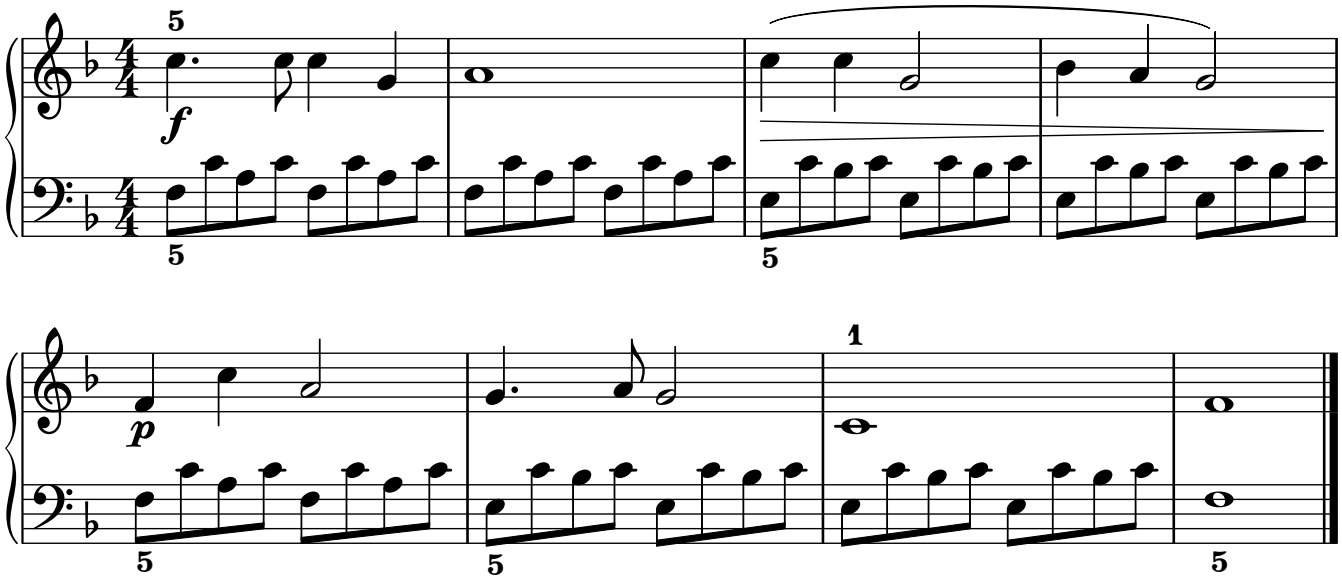


Part D: F major, the right hand on the move

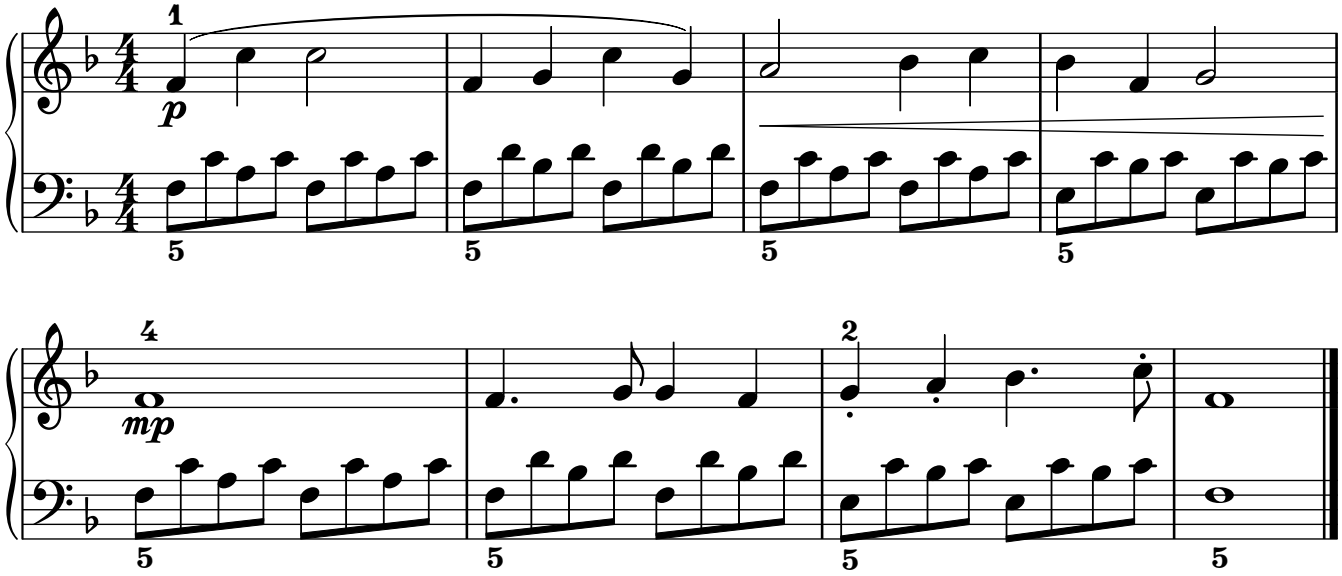
♩ = 60

F major. The right hand moves between F position and C position; watch for its finger numbers.

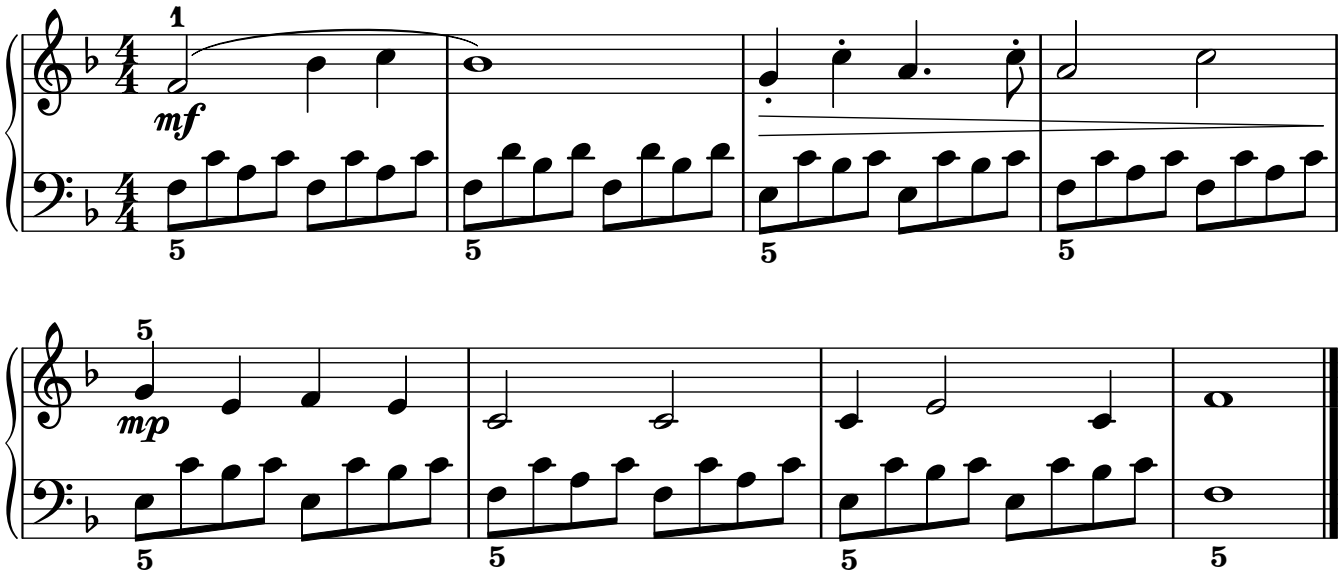
☐ **2.27**



☐ **2.28**



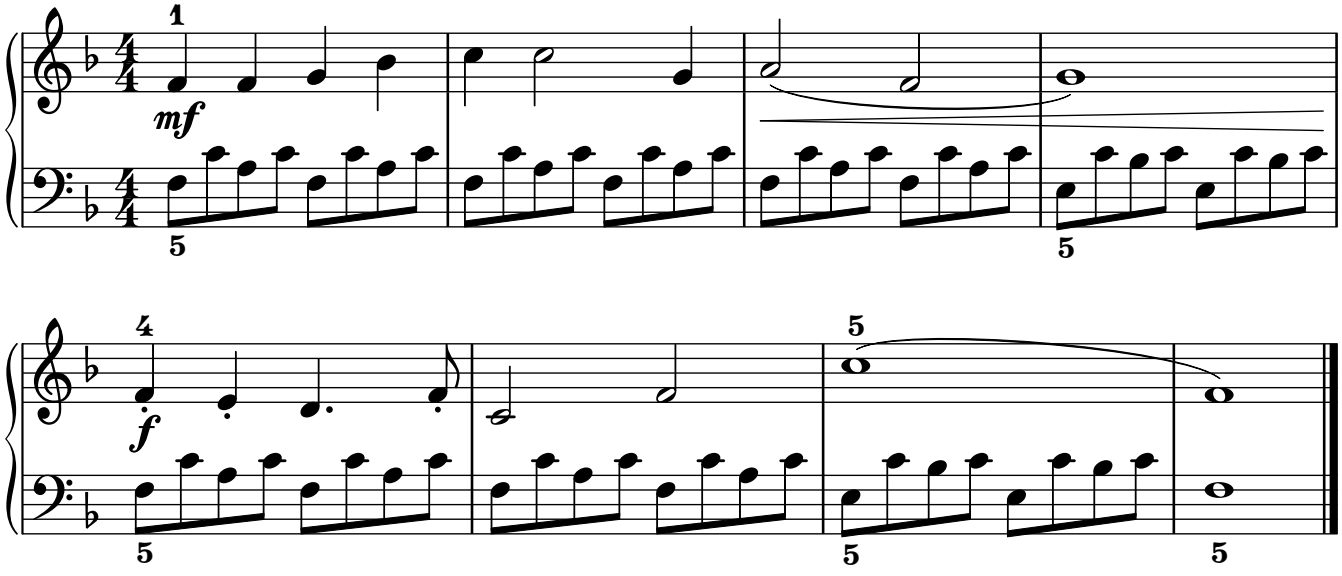
2.29



2.30



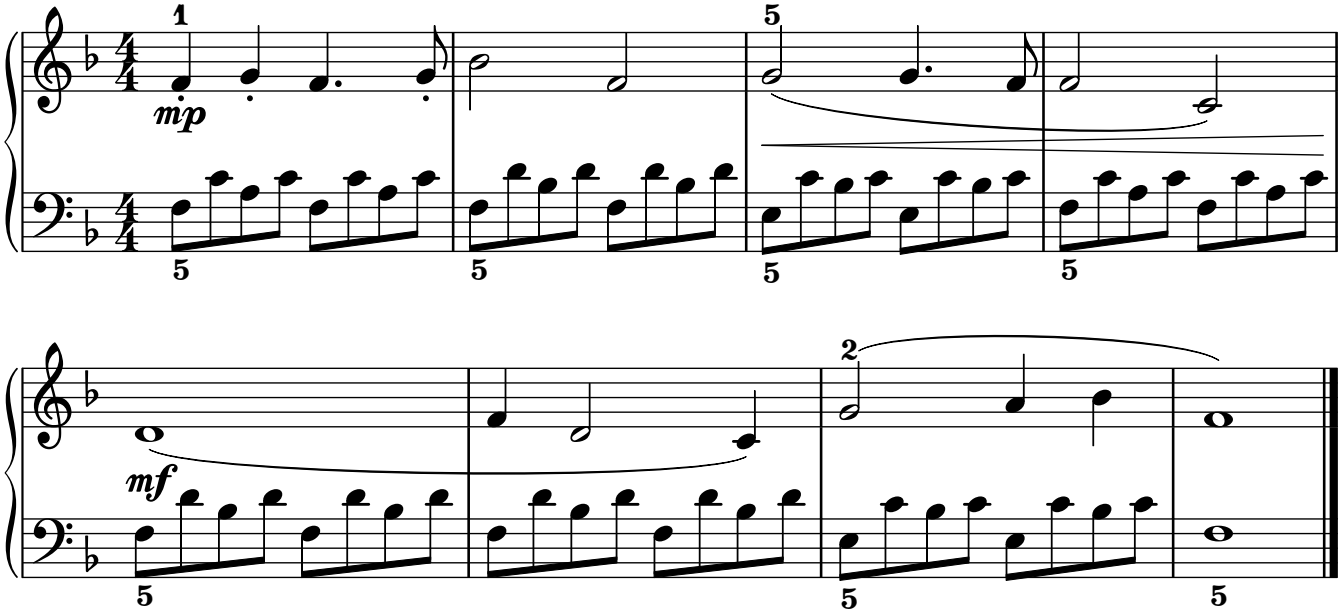
2.31



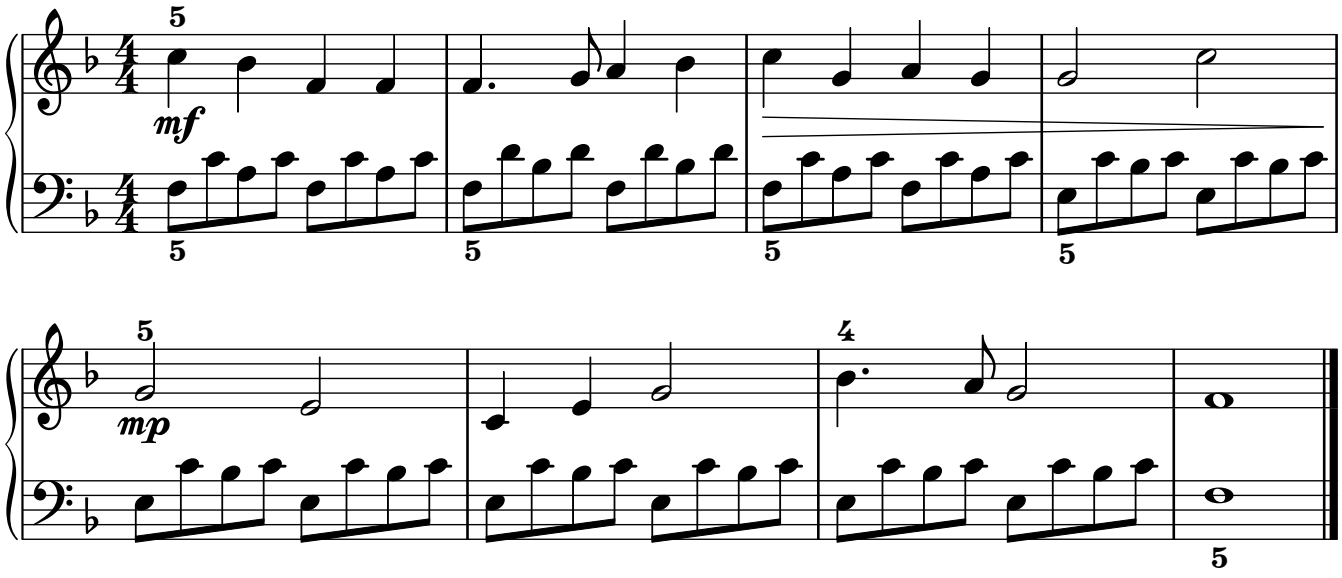
2.32



2.33



2.34



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star ♩ = 76

French folk tune 'Ah! vous dirai-je, maman' (18th century) - simplified

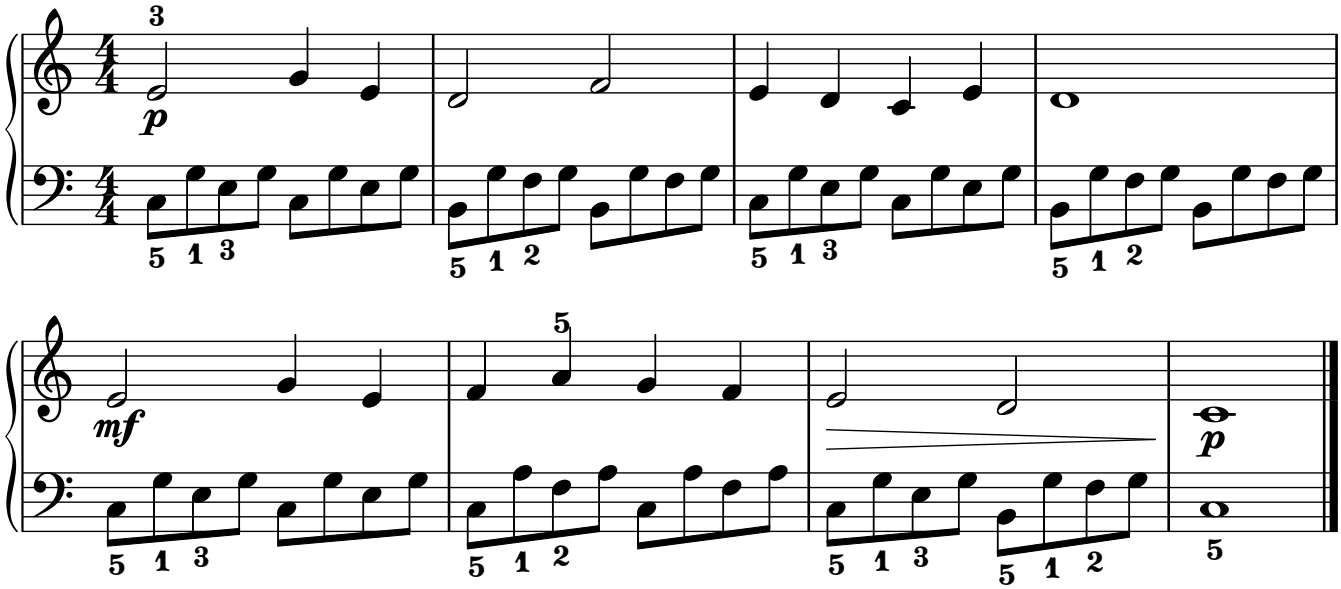
Mozart wrote twelve variations on this tune. Here the chord changes halfway through most bars, so each half bar has its own group of four eighths. The right hand stretches finger 5 up to A.



Little Sonata Theme ♩ = 72

Original

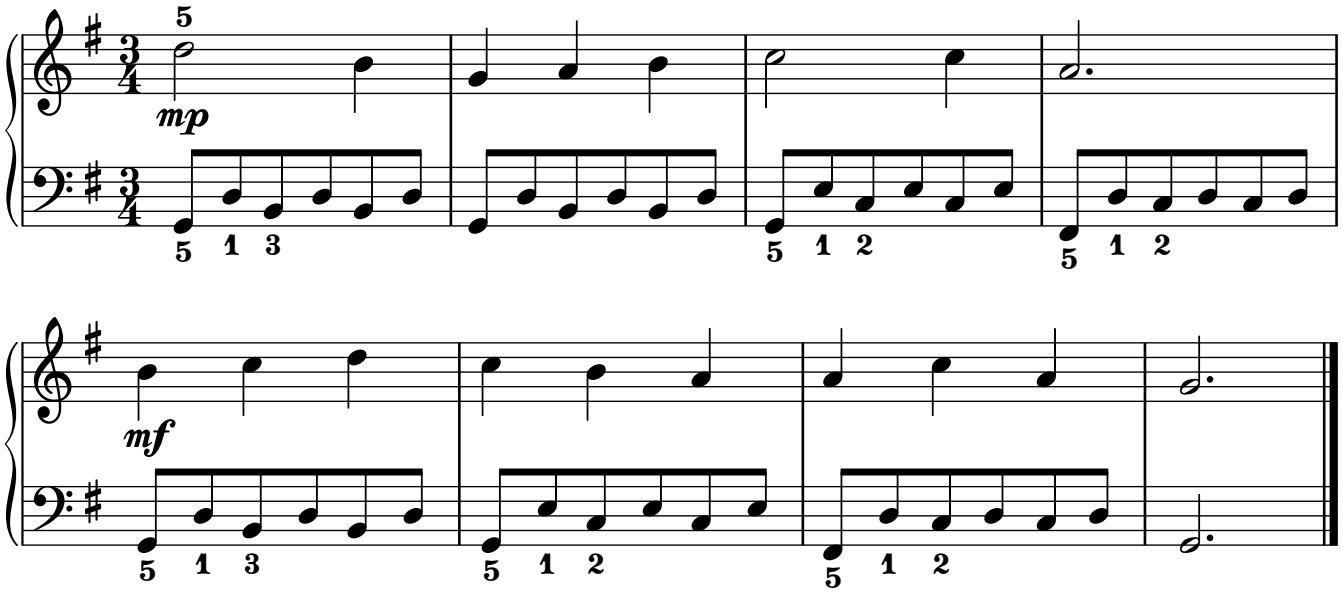
A tune in the style of a classical sonata. In bar 6 the right hand stretches finger 5 to A, and in bar 7 the chord changes halfway through the bar.



Alberti Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

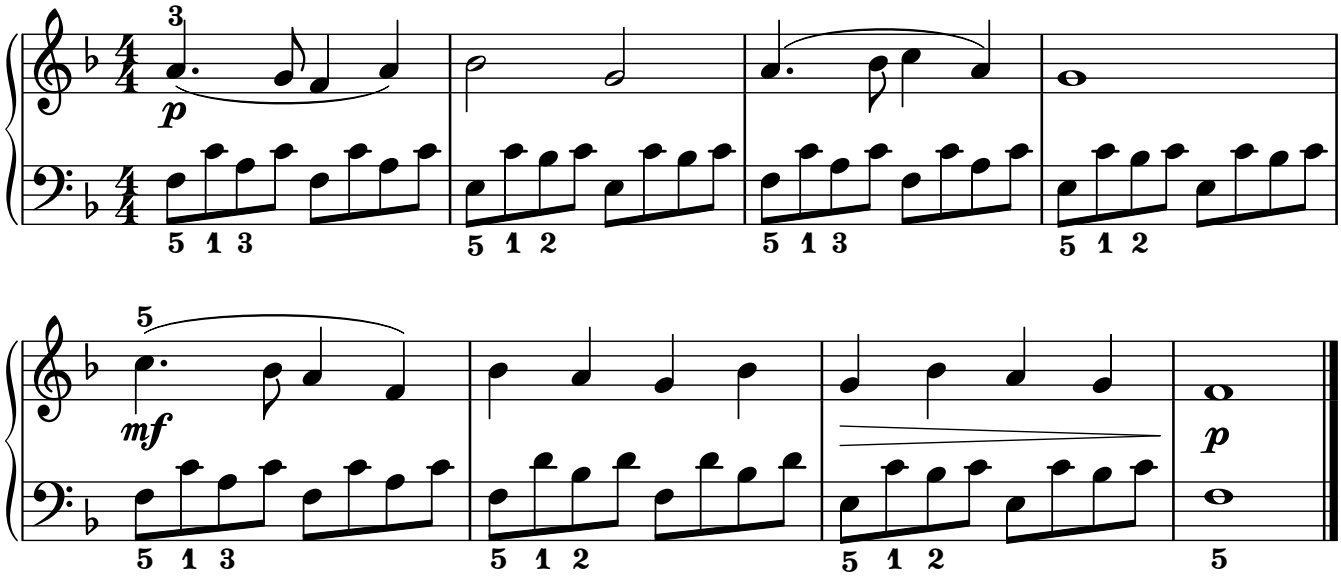
In 3/4 the Alberti pattern has six eighths: bottom, top, middle, top, middle, top. F-sharp is the bottom note of the V7 shape in bars 4 and 7.



Sunrise in F ♩ = 66

Original

Dotted rhythms over an Alberti bass in F major. B-flat is in both hands; in bar 6 the IV shape reaches up to D above middle C.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

- Play five new Part B or D exercises at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- The Alberti bass stays even and softer than the tune.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3.